

Data Description: US Disaster Declarations

Below is a field-by-field description of the two FEMA disaster datasets:

1. us_disaster_declarations.csv (full history) – 23 columns
2. us_disasters_m5.csv (restricted subset used in Modeling 5) – 14 columns

1. us_disaster_declarations.csv (23 Columns)

Column	Data Type	Description
fema_declaration_string	String	A composite string that uniquely identifies a declaration. Typically formatted as "<State>--<DisasterNumber>" (e.g., "TX-4487").
disaster_number	Integer	FEMA's numeric identifier for each declared event. E.g., 4487.
state	String	Two-letter U.S. postal abbreviation of the state where the disaster was declared (e.g., "TX," "CA").
declaration_type	String	Code indicating the type of declaration:
		• DR = Major Disaster Declaration
		• EM = Emergency Declaration
declaration_date	Date	Date on which FEMA officially declared the disaster (format: YYYY-MM-DD).
fy_declared	Integer	Federal fiscal year in which this disaster was declared (e.g., 2022).
incident_type	String	High-level categorization of the event (e.g., "Flood," "Hurricane," "Fire," "Tornado," "Winter Storm").
declaration_title	String	Descriptive title for the declaration, often including state and incident name (e.g., "HURRICANE LAURA").

ih_program_declared	Integer (0/1)	Flag indicating whether the Individual Housing (IH) Program was approved (1 = Yes, 0 = No).
ia_program_declared	Integer (0/1)	Flag indicating whether the Individual Assistance (IA) Program was approved (1 = Yes, 0 = No).
pa_program_declared	Integer (0/1)	Flag indicating whether the Public Assistance (PA) Program was approved (1 = Yes, 0 = No).
hm_program_declared	Integer (0/1)	Flag indicating whether the Hazard Mitigation (HM) Program was approved (1 = Yes, 0 = No).
incident_begin_date	Date	Date when the incident began (format: YYYY-MM-DD). E.g., the first day of flooding or storm impact.
incident_end_date	Date	Date when the incident ended (format: YYYY-MM-DD).
disaster_closeout_date	Date	Date on which FEMA officially closed the disaster (format: YYYY-MM-DD). May be null if still open.
fips	Integer	Five-digit Federal Information Processing Standards (FIPS) code for the primary geographic area.
place_code	Integer	FEMA-specific code for the location; generally corresponds to a sub-county or city-level unit.
designated_area	String	Name of the area for which the declaration applies—usually a county or equivalent jurisdiction (e.g., “JEFFERSON County”).
declaration_request_number	String	Request number associated with the state’s application to FEMA for the declaration (e.g., “PRELIM-029”).
last_ia_filing_date	Date	Most recent date on which a state or local government submitted Individual Assistance documentation to FEMA (format: YYYY-MM-DD).
last_refresh	DateTime	Timestamp indicating when this record was last updated or refreshed in FEMA’s system (e.g., “2024-05-12 16:23:45”).

hash	String	Internal checksum or hash value used by FEMA's data system for record validation.
id	String	Globally unique identifier (UUID) for this record in the FEMA database.

2. us_disasters_m5.csv (14 Columns)

This is a filtered subset of the full "us_disaster_declarations.csv," containing only the core fields needed for Modeling 5. It excludes fields like [fema_declaration_string](#), fiscal year, place codes, etc.

Column	Data Type	Description
disaster_number	Integer	FEMA's numeric disaster identifier (same as in the full dataset).
state	String	Two-letter U.S. postal abbreviation of the state.
declaration_type	String	Type of declaration: "DR" (Major Disaster) or "EM" (Emergency).
declaration_date	Date	Date of the official FEMA declaration (YYYY-MM-DD).
incident_type	String	Broad event category (e.g., "Flood," "Hurricane," "Wildfire," "Winter Storm").
declaration_title	String	Descriptive title for the declared disaster.
ih_program_declared	Integer (0/1)	Flag (1 = Yes / 0 = No) indicating whether Individual Housing assistance was approved.
ia_program_declared	Integer (0/1)	Flag indicating whether Individual Assistance was approved.
pa_program_declared	Integer (0/1)	Flag indicating whether Public Assistance was approved.
hm_program_declared	Integer (0/1)	Flag indicating whether Hazard Mitigation assistance was approved.
incident_begin_date	Date	Date on which the disaster event started.
incident_end_date	Date	Date on which the disaster event ended.

fips	Integer	Five-digit FIPS code for the primary impacted county or equivalent area.
designated_area	String	Name of the designated jurisdiction (e.g., "HARRIS County").

